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brightonSEO. United Kingdom

Prove it: A digital PR Playbook for Winning AI Citations and Reporting GEO Impact



Jane Hunt

JBH - The Digital PR & SEO Agency

jbh.co.uk

We asked ChatGPT to:

compare lactase supplements on strength, effectiveness and value

“Lactase 9000 looks particularly competitive on value.”

Best balance of strength and value



Nature's Best Lactase 9000

Price not available · See merchants

For most adults, **Nature's Best Lactase 9000 looks particularly competitive on value**. Its current 60-tablet pack is £11.30, or around **19p per 9,000-FCC dose**. The 180-tablet pack is £29.50, bringing that down to around **16p per tablet**. Nature's Best says the tablets begin working within 30 minutes and recommends the 9,000-FCC dose for dairy-containing meals. Nature's Best

LactoJoy gives considerably more enzyme per tablet at 14,500 FCC, and the scored tablet means the dose can be reduced to about 7,250 FCC. At £29.99 for 80, though, each full-strength tablet costs about **37p**, more than twice the per-tablet price of the larger Nature's Best pack. LactoJoy

The important caveat is that **higher strength does not automatically mean greater symptom relief for everyone**. The ideal dose depends on how much lactose you consume and your residual lactase activity. Someone eating a modest amount of dairy may get the same practical benefit from 9,000 FCC as from 14,500 or 18,000 FCC.

My comparison: for routine meals, **9,000 FCC offers a strong combination of enzyme activity and cost**, with Nature's Best currently looking particularly good on price. For very dairy-heavy meals or people who regularly need multiple lower-strength tablets, **LactoJoy's 14,500 FCC dose becomes more attractive despite the higher cost per tablet**.

But could we prove what helped earn it?

Before I show you how we got there, a quick intro...

who is jane hunt of JBH

Worked for 13s >

Jane Hunt is the **co-founder and CEO of JBH**, a Manchester-based agency specialising in digital PR, SEO and generative-engine optimisation (GEO). She has more than a decade of industry experience and focuses on connecting PR activity with measurable search and commercial outcomes. She is also an author and regular industry speaker, including at BrightonSEO. JBH ↗, public profile ↗

The gap is the problem.

Everyone is talking about visibility in AI search.

But most teams still can’t answer.

- **Which customer questions matter?**
- **Why does one brand get recommended over another?**
- **Did our PR activity influence it**
- **How should we report that influence?**

Over the past year we've tested how digital PR can influence AI visibility

We tracked:

- 50 commercially relevant prompts
- 4 Products for 1 brand
- 4 AI platforms

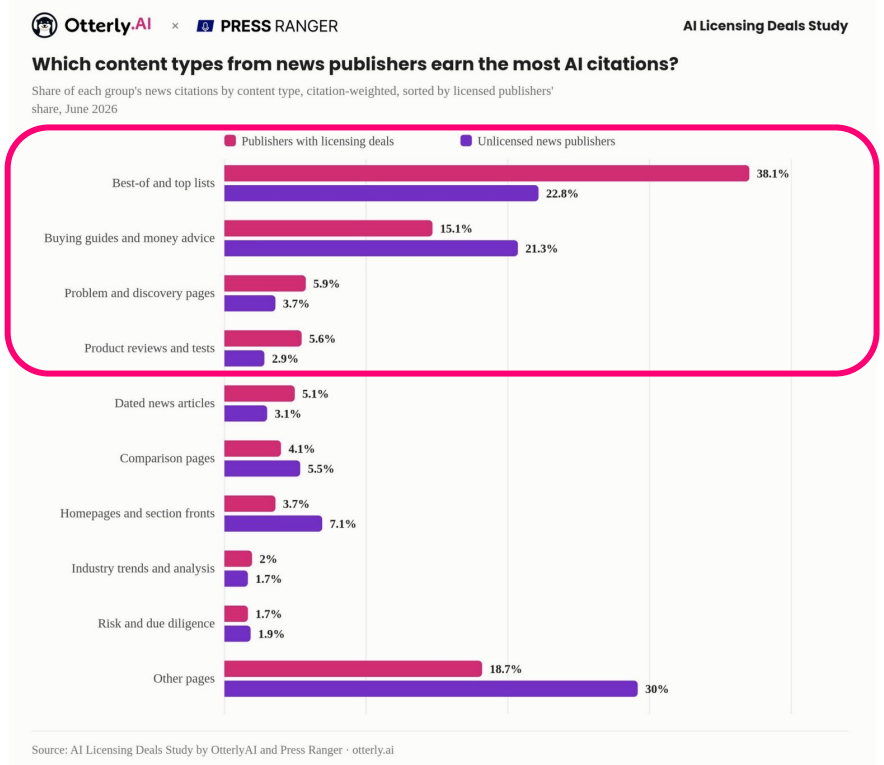
But what do we know already?

AI systems don’t cite all coverage equally

58.8% of citations came from commercial content:

- **38.1% Best-of & top lists**
- **15.1% Buying guides & money advice**
- **5.6% Product reviews & tests**
- **vs. 5.1% Dated news articles**

For AI visibility, the useful buying guide may be more valuable than the big news story.



OtterlyAI × Press Ranger, AI Licensing Deals Study, August 2026.

The PR brief has changed.

Matching the prompt is the new challenge.

The old thinking

Get the link

Chase DA/DR

Report placements

AI visibility thinking

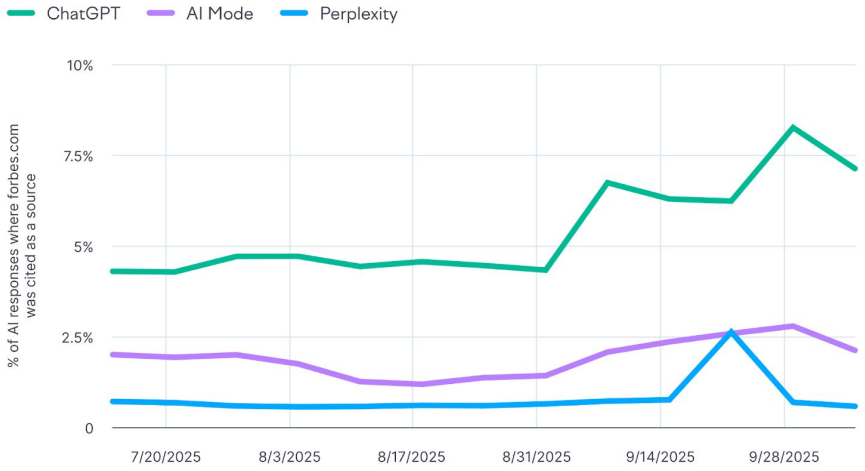
Answer the prompt

Find the sources AI cites

Report citation visibility / movement

Forbes: one of the most-cited publications in AI search - but not for business

% of AI Responses with a Forbes Citation



Based on a Semrush study of 230K prompts conducted in October 2025

semrush.com

SEMRUSH

Nearly 50% of AI citations are buying guides, best-of lists and product reviews on big publications.

Think Vetted, Advisor, Health.

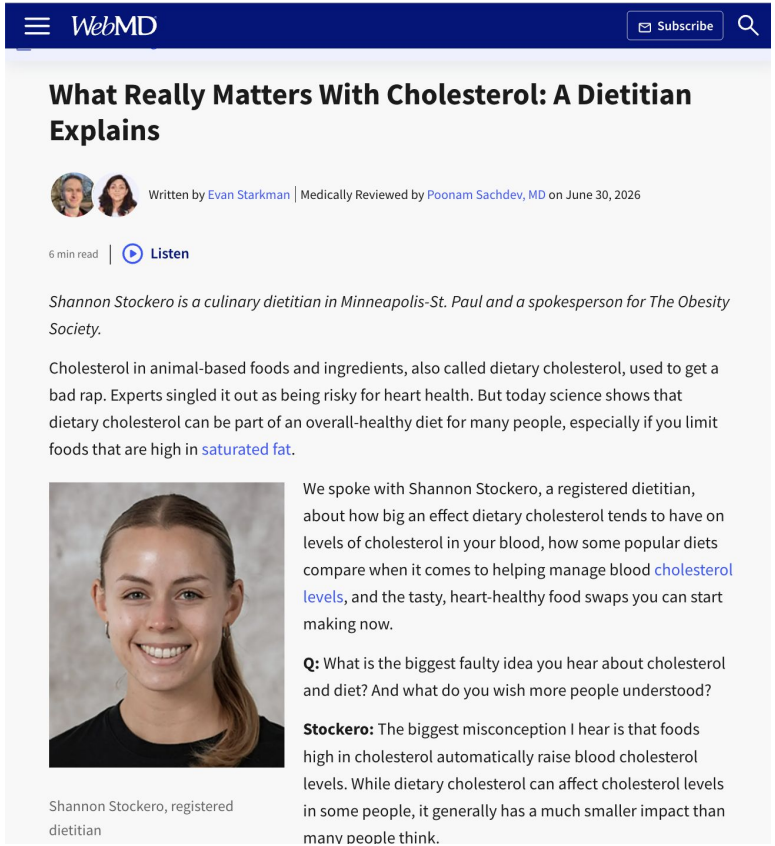
The health site everyone recognises isn't necessarily the source AI cites most.

Across almost 825,000 health citations:

- **WebMD: 0.28%**
- **Healthline: 0.78%**
- **YouTube: 3.27%**
- **PubMed Central: 4.08%**

Brand recognition alone doesn't determine citation visibility.

Source: LLM Pulse Study, July 2026



This means brand recognition alone doesn’t determine citation visibility.

The metrics we've optimised around for a decade are not the metrics AI tools reward.

Most digital PR reporting tells us:

- ✔ How many placements we earned
- ✔ Which sites linked
- ✔ How authoritative those sites are
- ✔ Where the links point to
- ✔ Any referral traffic

They rarely tell us:

- ✗ Customer Qs the coverage answers
- ✗ If AI systems use those sources
- ✗ If mentioned, cited or recommended
- ✗ If visibility improved vs competitors
- ✗ Which activity made the change

Meet the 3 P’s;
The levers that actually move AI visibility

Lever 1

Prompts

Choose the customer questions worth influencing

Lever 2

Publishers

Place relevant evidence in the sources AI already uses

Lever 3

Proof

Measure what changed and report only what the evidence supports

Lever 1

Prompts

Don’t start with:

“What campaign could earn links?”

Start with:

“Which customer question do we want our brand to appear in?”

A prompt reveals the customer's:

- **Need**
- **Context**
- **Funnel stage**
- **Decision criteria**

Gives PR a more commercial brief

Build a prompt set that reflects the customer journey.

Problem: “What can help with high cholesterol?”

Education: “How do plant sterols work?”

Comparison: “Plant sterols vs red yeast rice”

Recommendation: “Best supplement for cholesterol support”

Validation: “Are plant sterol supplements worth it?”

Score each prompt against:

- Commercial relevance
- Product priority
- Customer intent
- Current visibility gap
- Ability to contribute credible evidence

Then freeze a representative prompt set before activity begins.

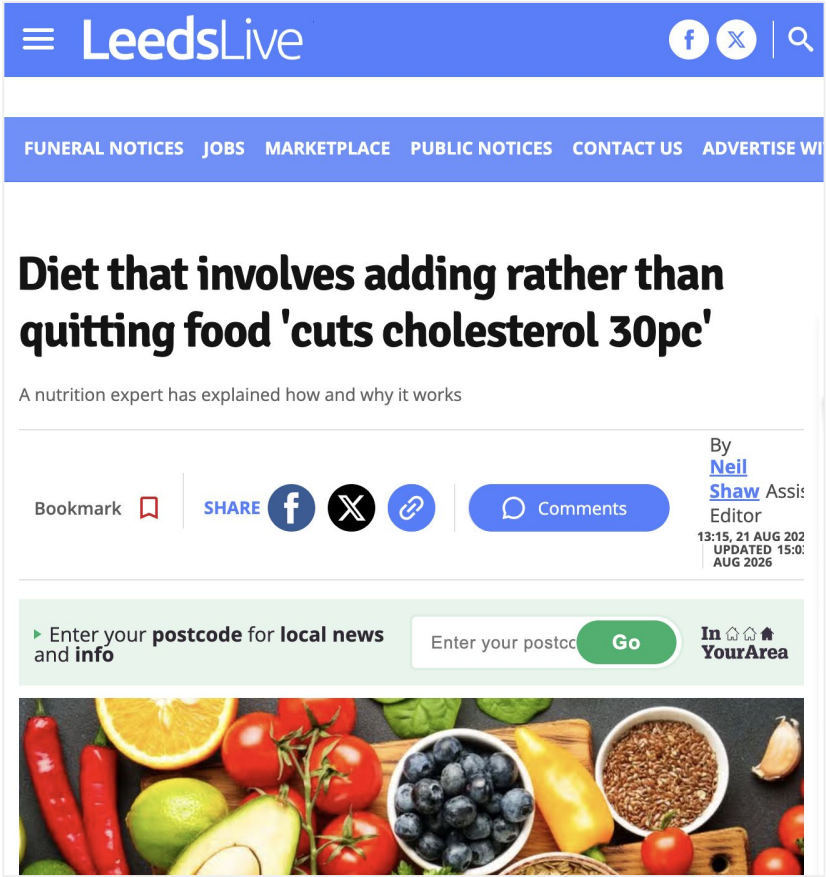
But keep to a number that is measurable and meaningful.

Prioritise prompts that matter.

We created expert-led content about:

- **Cholesterol management**
- **Where plant sterols fit**
- **Evidence of use**

The aim? Give publishers accurate, extractable evidence that answered the underlying question.



Lever 2

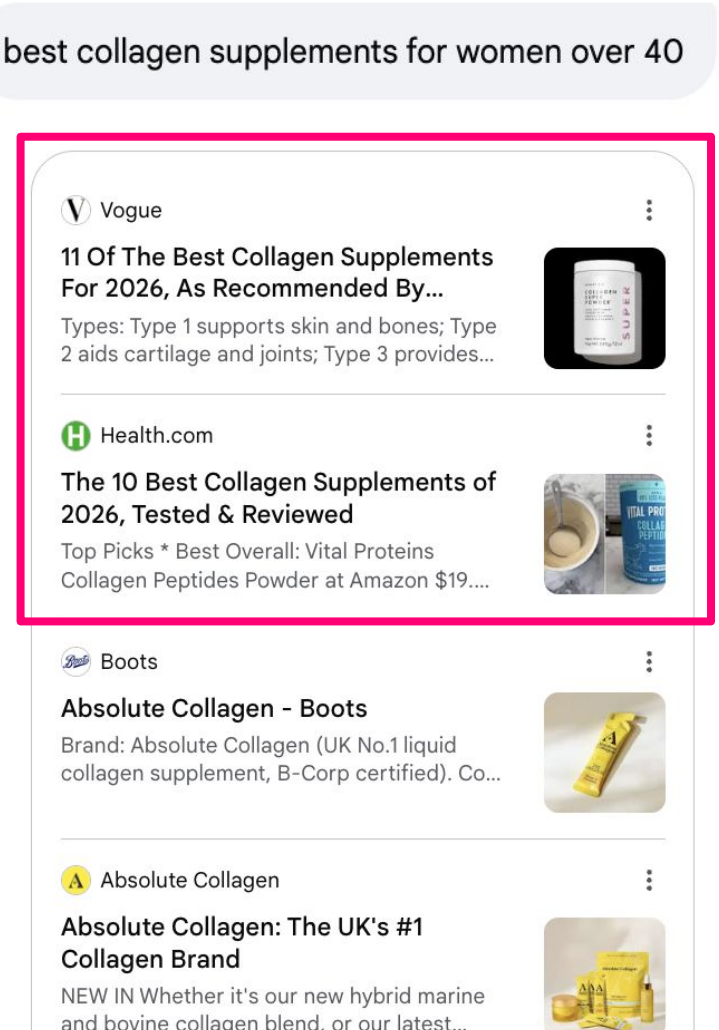
Publishers

The good news?

Our AI prompt results already contain the start of a media list.

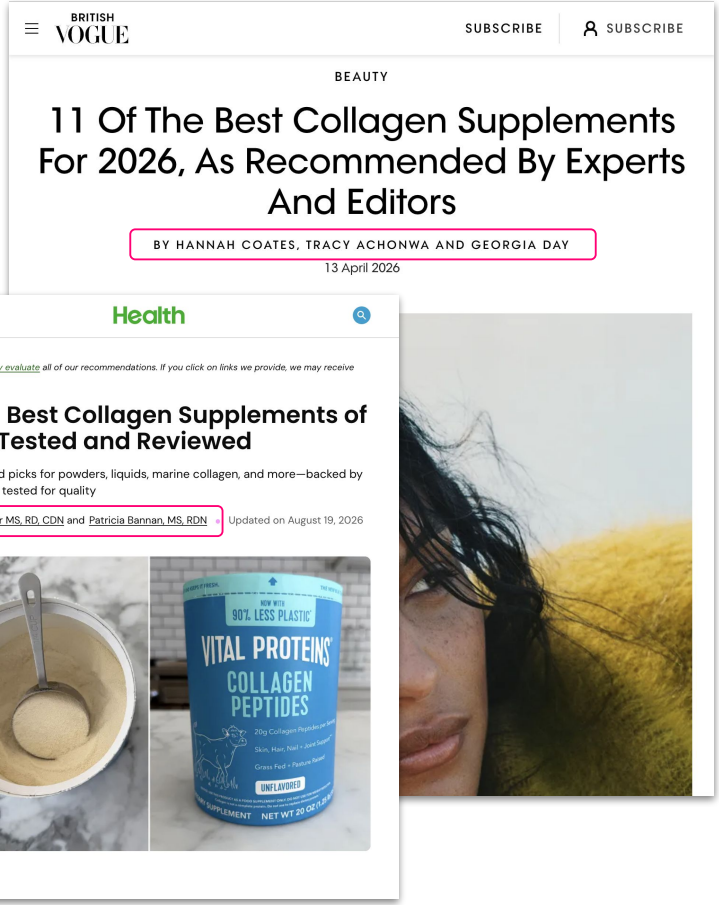
For each prompt note:

- The domains cited
- The pages cited
- The content formats
- Recurring sources
- Competitors included



Target the page:

“Earn inclusion in the Vogue guide that repeatedly appears for our collagen prompts.”



Identify the exact article or guide:

The editor / reviewing team, how often its updated and the evidence required for inclusion + the product context

Licensing deals are a signal,
not a shortcut.

In a 2026 study, news pages from publishers with OpenAI licensing deals received 48% more ChatGPT citations per cited page.

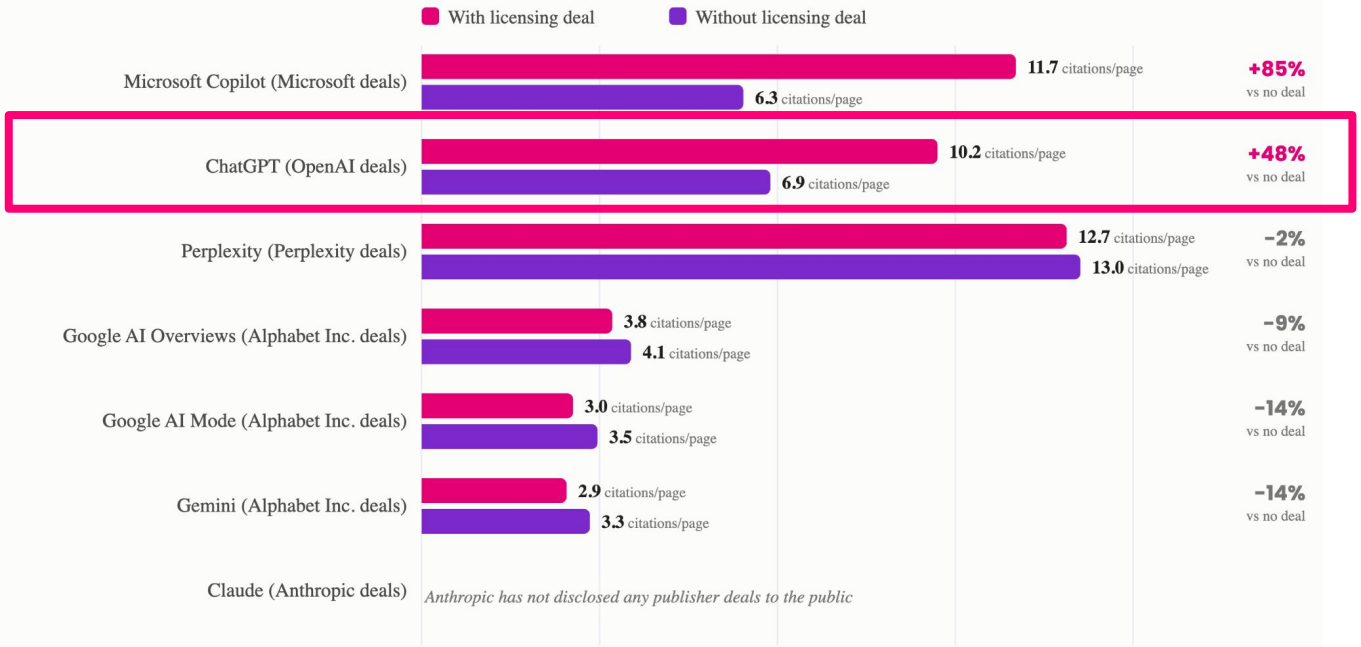
SOURCE: OtterlyAI × Press Ranger, August 2026

Otterly.AI × PRESS RANGER

AI Licensing Deals Study

Does a deal with a news publisher earn more AI citations per page?

Publishers licensed by each platform's owner vs publishers with no deal, average citations per cited news page, June 2026



Source: AI Licensing Deals Study by OtterlyAI and PressRanger · otterly.ai

BUT the study found an association, not proof that the deal caused the difference.

Use licensing status as one prioritisation signal, not the only one.

Across 16 industry prompt sets:

Niche and trade media received 75.8% of news citations vs 24.2% for mainstream media

Here is your publisher workflow...

Run the prompt set

Record recurring sources / pages

Analyse whether: comparisons, expertise or product context

Identify gaps the brand can fill

Pitch the page, editor or format

Rerun the prompt set after publication.

The strongest placement isn't the site with the highest DA, most recognisable masthead, or article with the most backlinks.

It's the one with a customer question to credible evidence and to your brand or product.

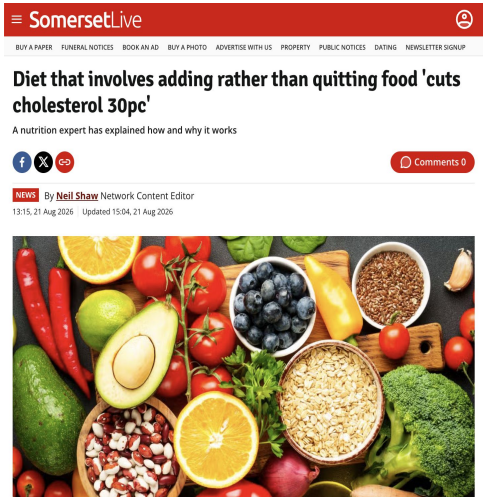
Plant sterols, the evidence chain - how we did this for our client

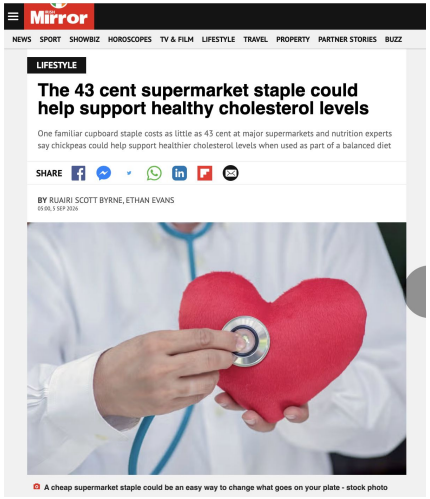
Prompts / themes with weak visibility

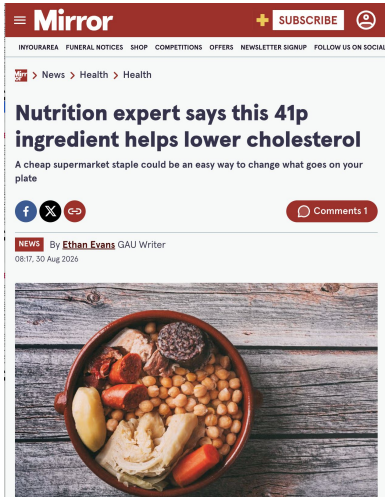
“Which plant sterol supplement is easiest to take consistently every day?”

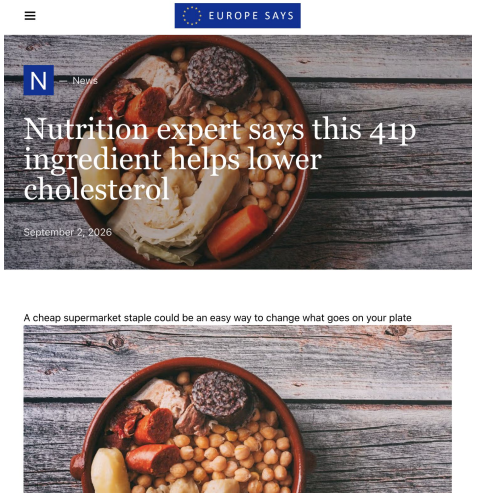
“Recommended cholesterol support for someone who struggles to eat enough plant sterols through food.”

PR response: Expert-led coverage about cholesterol and the Portfolio Diet









Earned result:

- 8 pieces of regional coverage +
- 25 links to the relevant product page

Visibility movement:

- Domain citations up from 172 to 225
- Brand coverage up from 22% to 25%

The product now appears in answers about cholesterol-support supplements.

Which plant sterol supplement is easiest to take consistently every day?

For consistency, I'd favour something you can attach to the same meal every day. A **single daily fortified yogurt drink** is probably the easiest format overall because one serving typically gives around **2g of plant sterols or stanols**, which sits within the 1.5 to 3g daily range supported by HEART UK and the BHF. They recommend taking sterols or stanols every day and with a meal. British ... +1

If you specifically want a **tablet supplement**, the main thing to check is how many tablets you need to reach an effective daily amount. Many UK products contain around **800mg per tablet**, which means you may need multiple tablets daily depending on the manufacturer's directions. That can make adherence harder than a one-serving food product. Examples currently available include Nature's Best Plant Sterols, Lamberts Plant Sterols 800mg and Boots Max Strength Plant Sterols 1000mg Capsules.



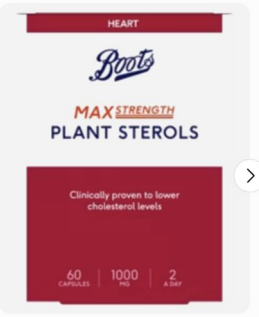
Nature's Best Plant Sterols

Price not available • Natural plant sterols supplement, suitable for heart health.



Lamberts Plant Sterols 800mg

Price not available • High-strength plant sterols for cholesterol support.



Boots Max Strength Plant Sterols 1000mg Capsules

Price not available • Max strength capsules for cholesterol management.

Give feedback

One important caveat: the BHF says the strongest evidence is for **sterol/stanol-fortified foods**, while supplement formulations and doses vary more. British Heart Fo...

But we didn’t win them all.

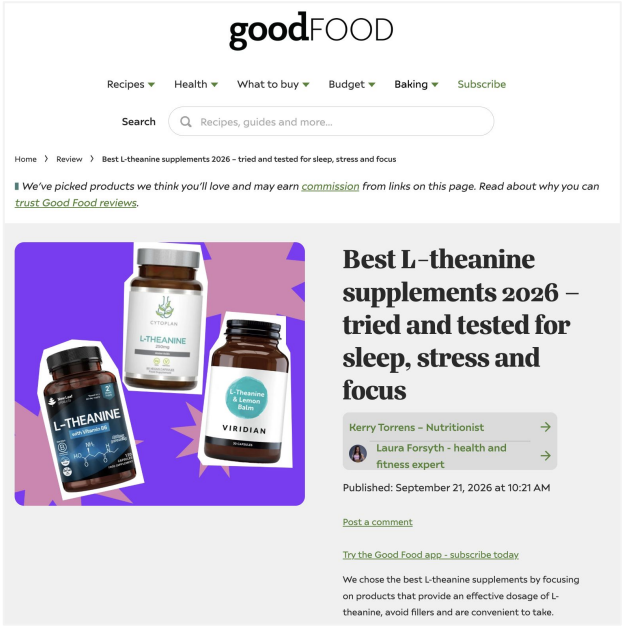
Lactase looked like our strongest product:

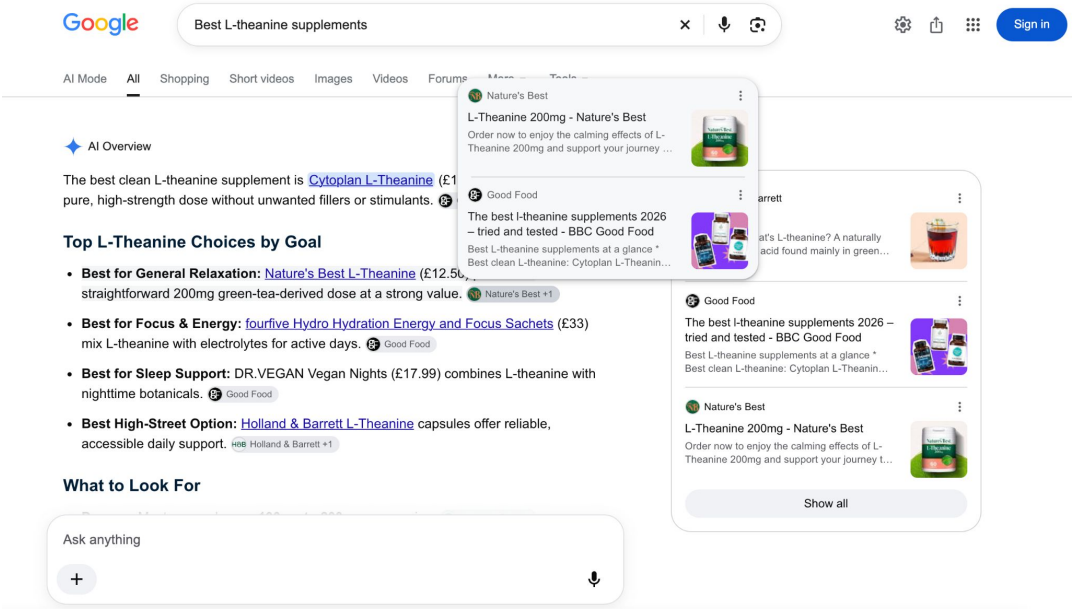
- **41% share of voice**
- **First competitive position**

But was going up and down:

- Prompt coverage fell from 32 to 28
- “Holiday bloating” up 22% to 30%
- The product moved to 1st
- Visibility declined for hidden-dairy and digestive-discomfort prompts

The product pitch with impact





Top citation sources

Every domain AI platforms cited when answering your prompts, classified so you can see who owns the answer. Select any domain to see the exact pages cited.

Search domain | CSV

You **2%** · Competitor **15%** · Retailer **13%** · Publisher **4%** · Social media **3%** · Reference **17%** · Other **45%**

All sources | You 1 | Competitors 9 | Retailers 10 | Publishers 7 | Social media 4 | Reference 9 | Other 93

Domain	Citations	Share	Prompts	URLs	Platforms	Last cited
bbcgoodfood.com Publisher	5	1%	5	1	2	29/09/2026
tollbit.bbcgoodfood.com Publisher	5	1%	4	1	2	29/09/2026
healthline.com Publisher	3	1%	3	1	1	29/09/2026
vitaminexpress.org Publisher	2	0%	2	1	2	29/09/2026
webmd.com Publisher	2	0%	2	1	2	29/09/2026

Rows per page 5 | Showing 1–5 of 7 domains | « ‹ 1 2 › »

Lever 3

Proof

“Trust me, it’s working”
will not protect a GEO budget.

A defensible report must show:

- What we targeted
- What we changed
- What moved
- Evidence connecting activity to impact
- What we still cannot claim

Report in 3 Layers...

Layer One

Visibility

Are we mentioned, cited or recommended for the prompts that matter?

Layer Two

Competitive Movement

Are we gaining or losing share against a defined competitor set?

Layer Three

Business Signals

Did branded search, traffic or assisted conversions move alongside visibility?

Define the metrics before measuring

Prompt coverage: % of tracked prompts where brand appears

Citation rate: % of brand citations

Share of Voice:
Brand Mentions as share of tracked competitor mentions

Product mentions:
% responses mentioning the product (recommendations)

Movement: Changes across prompts / platforms

The result a stakeholder can understand

- **Product X - July to August:**
  - Domain citations increased from 589 to 1,500
  - Citation share increased from 2.77% to 2.82%
  - Share of voice reached 42%
  - Ranked first, 2 points ahead of competitor

- **Activity during the period:**
  - Product and healthy-ageing coverage on GoodFood, Olive, MSN

- **Important context:**
  - Tracked prompt set expanded from 9 to 26.

When the CFO asks about revenue

What we can prove	What we can investigate	What we won't claim without evidence
• Citations • Mentions • Recommendations • Competitive share across a defined prompt set	• Referral traffic • Branded search • Qualified visits • Assisted conversions • Movement following specific coverage	• That one placement directly caused revenue • That every visibility increase came from PR • That one month's movement represents a lasting trend

For your next brief...

1

Define the customer convo not the keyword

2

Baseline a fixed prompt set before activity starts

3

Use existing sources cited to build a media list

4

Connect pitches to a prompt and a measurable result

Lastly - prove it:

- Show the question you targeted
- Show the evidence you placed
- Show the answer that changed

Be honest about what you can’t claim

Thank you!

AI search will keep changing.
Let’s keep testing and proving what works.



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